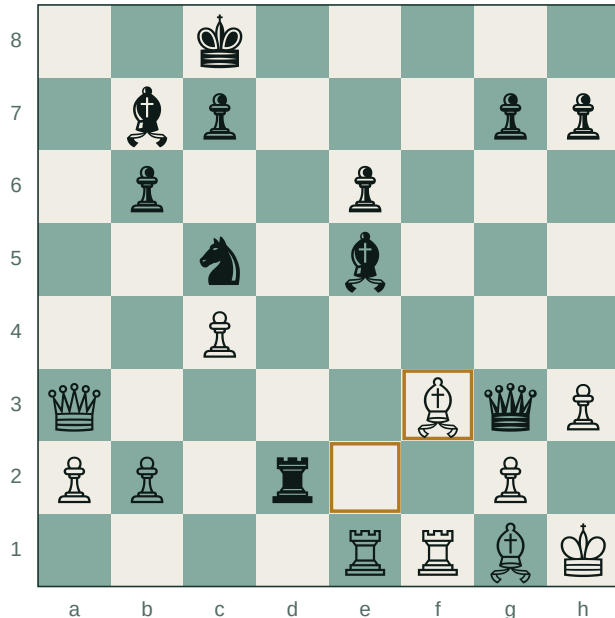


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 25

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 25.Bxf3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25...Qxg2+ 26. Bxg2 Bxg2#

25...Qxg2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From g2 it attacks king on h1, rook on f1 and bishop on g1. Recorded reply: **26.Bxg2**.

26...Bxg2# Mate: bishop on g2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Bishop on g2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on h1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.